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ESSAY CONTENT

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An eye for an eye.....

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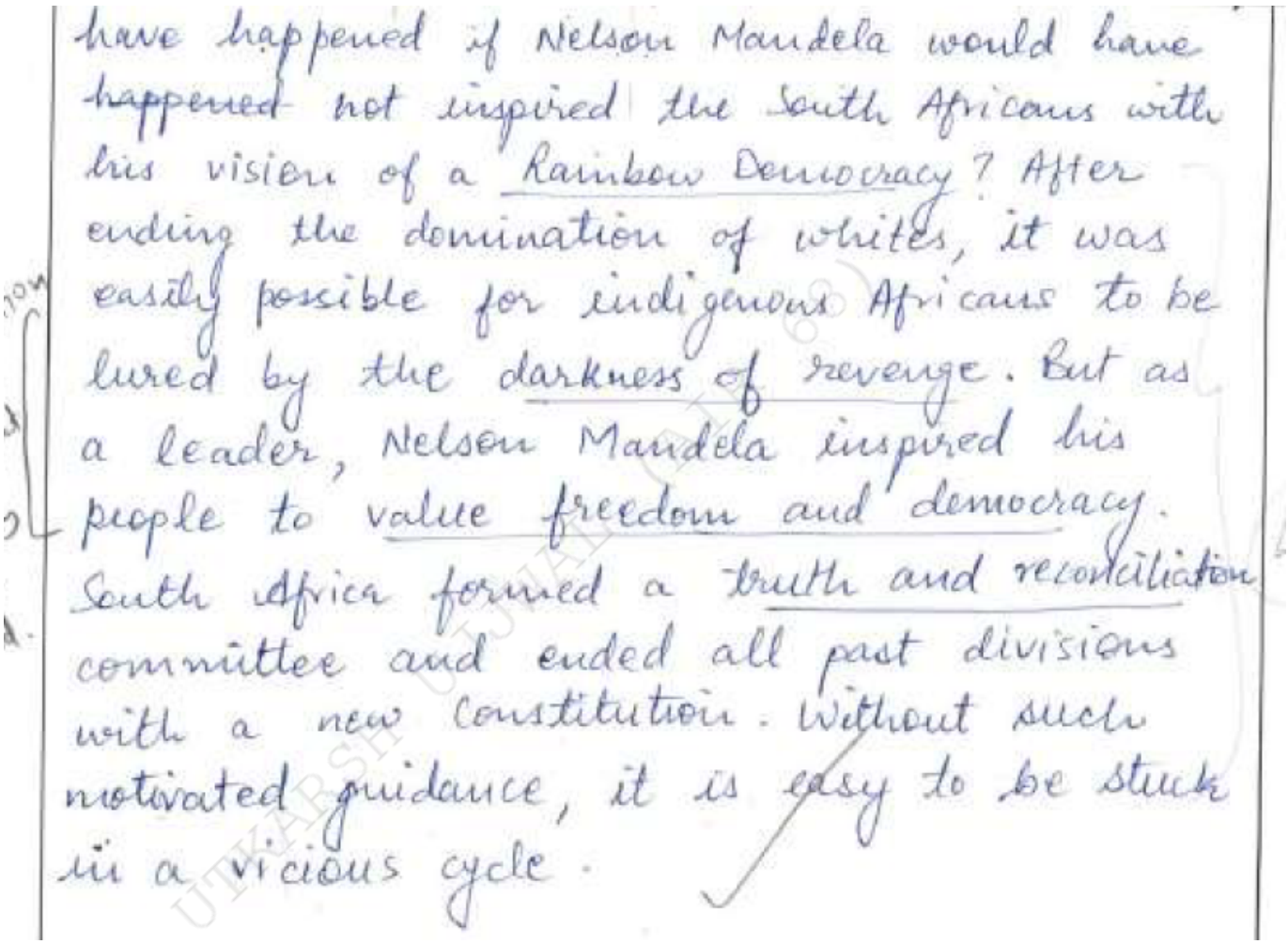
- 

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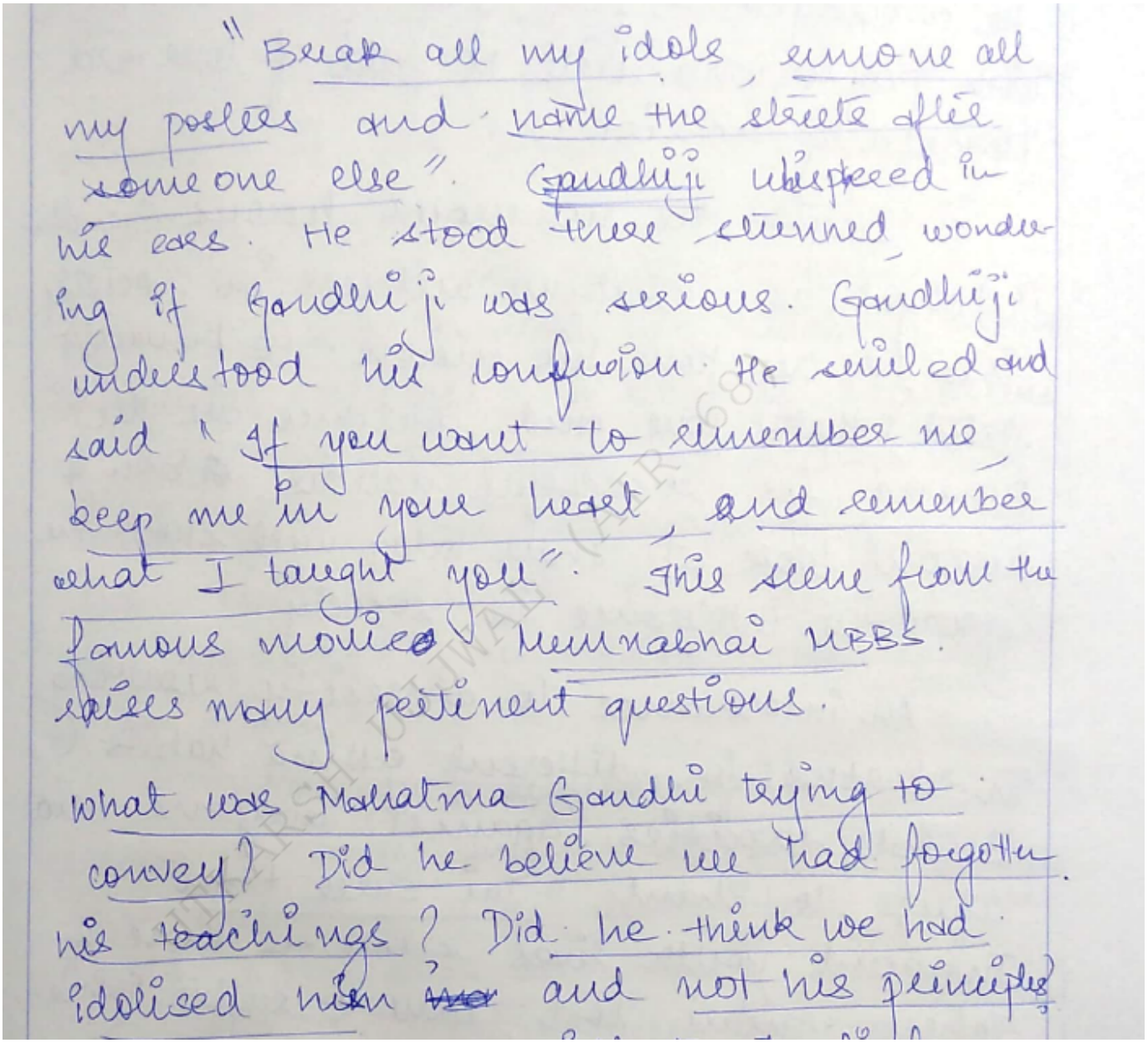
- 
"Break all my idols, remove all my posters and name the streets after someone else". Gandhiji whispered in his ears. He stood there stunned wondering if Gandhiji was serious. Gandhiji understood his confusion. He smiled and said "If you want to remember me, keep me in your heart, and remember what I taught you". This scene from the famous movies Munnabhai MBBS raises many pertinent questions.

What was Mahatma Gandhi trying to convey? Did he believe we had forgotten his teachings? Did he think we had idolised him and not his principles

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Commitment to ideals, not idols, is the need of the hour.

The Nuremberg trials were conducted to hold the people responsible for atrocities committed during Nazi Germany. Generals, soldiers were asked to answer "Why did you do it?". Some answered that they were following orders. Some replied with "Hail Hitler" while some simply did not know any better. The trials raised very valid questions and became important for future psychological studies.

Were the soldiers blinded by their loyalty to the leader? Did they follow any principles? Why did not their "conscience" stop them from carrying out heinous crimes! In this essay we attempt to answer some of these questions and analyse the importance of ideals

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INDIGENISING THE DEFENSE SECTOR: STATUS, CHALLENGES, AND OPPORTUNITIES

The year was 1971. A bitter war for Bangladesh's liberation was being fought between India and Pakistan. Pakistan's allies - USA and China were naturally hoping for a Pakistani victory. The USA, in this pursuit, withdrew Global Positioning system (GPS) support to the Indian army.

Though India emerged victorious, the strategic imperatives of indigenising the defense sector were well-understood. Fast-forward to 2018, where India launched a seven-satellite indigenous

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See pen change

comes with ... acceptance, respect and enhancement of freedom of all of us.

The words of TAGORE can be a way ahead for all of us:

"Where the minds are without fear, and the head is held high;
Where the knowledge is free,
Where the world has not been broken into fragments, by narrow domestic walls
. . . .
Into that 'heaven of FREEDOM'
My Father, LET MY COUNTRY AWAKE"

Pose a questn at the end of para

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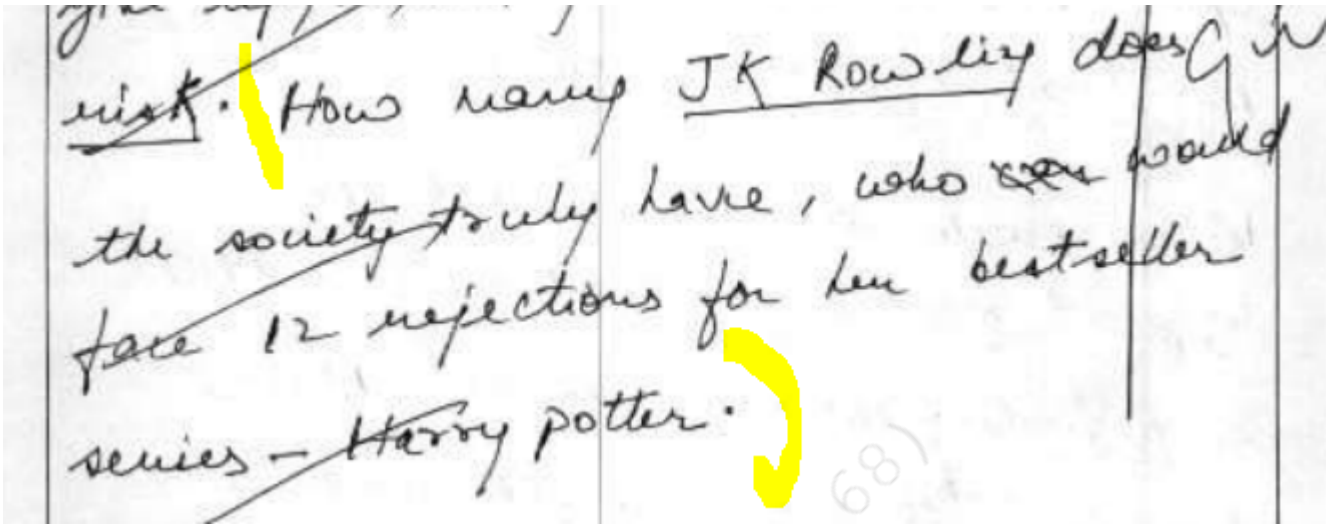
- 
risk. How many JK Rowling does G in the society truly have, who would face 12 rejections for her bestseller series - Harry potter.

- He live in an era of contrasts. Every morning there are some who start running to burn their excess belly fat, simultaneously on same roads there are sweeping millions who start their day running for both ends meal. Rightly said by someone "India is poor country of Rich people".

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Men have become tools of their tools

These immortal words said by Henry Thoreau, bring to the forth the reality which is striking mankind. The very act of creating a means to an ends has become an end in itself. All around us we are exposed to the dangers of the tools which we had created harming us to the extent of dehumanising humanity. Our touch with the real world is diminishing. Slowly ours able to think, reason, behave would come to be dominated by the tools we have

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Test series answer sheets-

- focus on Intro

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1. OUR GREATEST GLORY IS NOT IN NEVER FALLING, BUT IN RISING EVERY TIME WE FALL.

On the inauguration of his presidentship, Nelson Mandela was asked by a reporter about what had kept him going all these years against the Apartheid regime - even after two dozen years in prison. Mandela's answer was simple: he quoted his favourite poem 'Invictus' and remarked "I am the master of my fate, I am the captain of my soul."

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3. UNIVERSITIES SHOULD BE A PLACE FOR 'CREATIVITY', 'OUT OF BOX THINKING' AND 'IDEOLOGICAL DISRUPTIONS'.

'Students must be taught how to think, not what to think.' This enlightening quote by Margaret Mead shook the 20th century global system of education by its roots. Education at that time was designed to be a 'submissive' and morally imposed knowledge infiltrated through a hierarchial structure. ~~Universities of the~~

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Q4: INTELLIGENCE IS NOT IQ, BUT CAPACITY OF IMAGINATION.

"Logic can take you from 'A' to 'B', but imagination can take you anywhere." When Albert Einstein said these words, the world was trapped in the clutches of withering 'Feudalism' that was making way for a new world order. However, the thoughts of the populace were still bound by tradition and war. What was needed to solve this stagnation was - imagination.

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4. INDIAN AGRICULTURE IS, IN A WAY, A VICTIM OF ITS OWN PAST SUCCESS

The diverse terrain and the rich variety of orographic and ecological features bestow upon the country of India a considerably large potential of crop cultivation. From the Saffron fields in the upper reaches of the Himalayas to the cereal production power houses on the Alluvial plains, huge yields of cash crops in the Deccan peninsula to 'horticultural hotspots' spread throughout the country: an 'Agro-economy'.

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3. The Refugee Crisis Shows World's Moral Failure

When Nobel Laureate 'Gurudev' Rabindranath Tagore exclaims - "Where the mind is without fear, and the world is not fragmented by boundaries", he emphasises on the liberty that is innate to the human soul. He wishes for an 'eternal brotherhood' to proliferate in the global community. A century after those lines were written, the community still confronts the virtues of fear, hatred, terror and divisiveness in the form of a 'refugee crisis'.

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CHILD LABOUR : A NECESSARY EVIL OR JUST PLAIN EVIL ?

Working with tools and teacups,
The little hands move everyday
For need and for survival,
They are ready to walk everyway

Some have an ailing sister
While some have a mother
To get home a penny
They get beaten by the 'other'.

Do these kids know, they are losing their childhood ??

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THE CHANGING IDENTITIES OF CITIES IN 21ST CENTURY

"On a warm summer morning, workers set out with their tools straight to the factories. The smoke from burning coal ~~emo~~ rising high. Few vehicles and trendy cars making their way through roads. Shops on streets lining up for customers. The Cinema too getting ready to put up a 'black & white' show. There are also some poor kids selling newspapers while some labourers laying bricks."

This portrayl of an EARLY CITY, today seems to be taken over by a new identity. what brings to our mind today when we talk of a city? Skyscrapers of [illegible] Bustling streets of Kolkata,

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UN reforms: a step long overdue

Some of the national dailies had following headlines in the recent past:

- USA pulls out of the Iran nuclear deal similar to its withdrawal from Paris climate deal and the UNESCO.
- Saudi Arabia led coalition attacks Yemen.
- Nuclear weapons of North Korea threaten to hit Guam 'enveloping it in fire'.
- USA and China launch fresh set of tariffs on each other deepening the trade war.

While nations are going for such unilateral actions that have repercussions for entire globe, a common question arises as to where is the United Nations (UN). Does the UN has no role to play in these times of global turbulences?

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Big Data: lifeblood of decision-making and prudent governance in the contemporary era

A recent Reserve Bank of India (RBI) report reveals that India's Non-Performing Assets (NPAs) have touched a new high of 11.6% in March 2018. It cautions that NPAs are bound to rise and may reach 12.2% by March 2019. This prompted many economists to find solutions to India's bourgeoning crisis of NPAs. Among all solutions proposed, few technological experts highlighted the potential of BIG DATA to solve this problem. They suggested that banks can use big data to keep a track on their borrowers.

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Innovation and Entrepreneurship in India: Opportunities and Challenges

A Dalit by birth, Kalpana Saroj was married at the age of 12. Facing harassment from her husband, she was rescued by her father. There was a time when Kalpana Saroj was forced to work for ₹2 a day. She started a garment factory in Mumbai and today, she runs a $100 million garment industry! A real 'slumdog millionaire', she was awarded Padma Shri in 2013.

The above example shows the potential of innovation and entrepreneurship to transform a person's life; from rags to riches.

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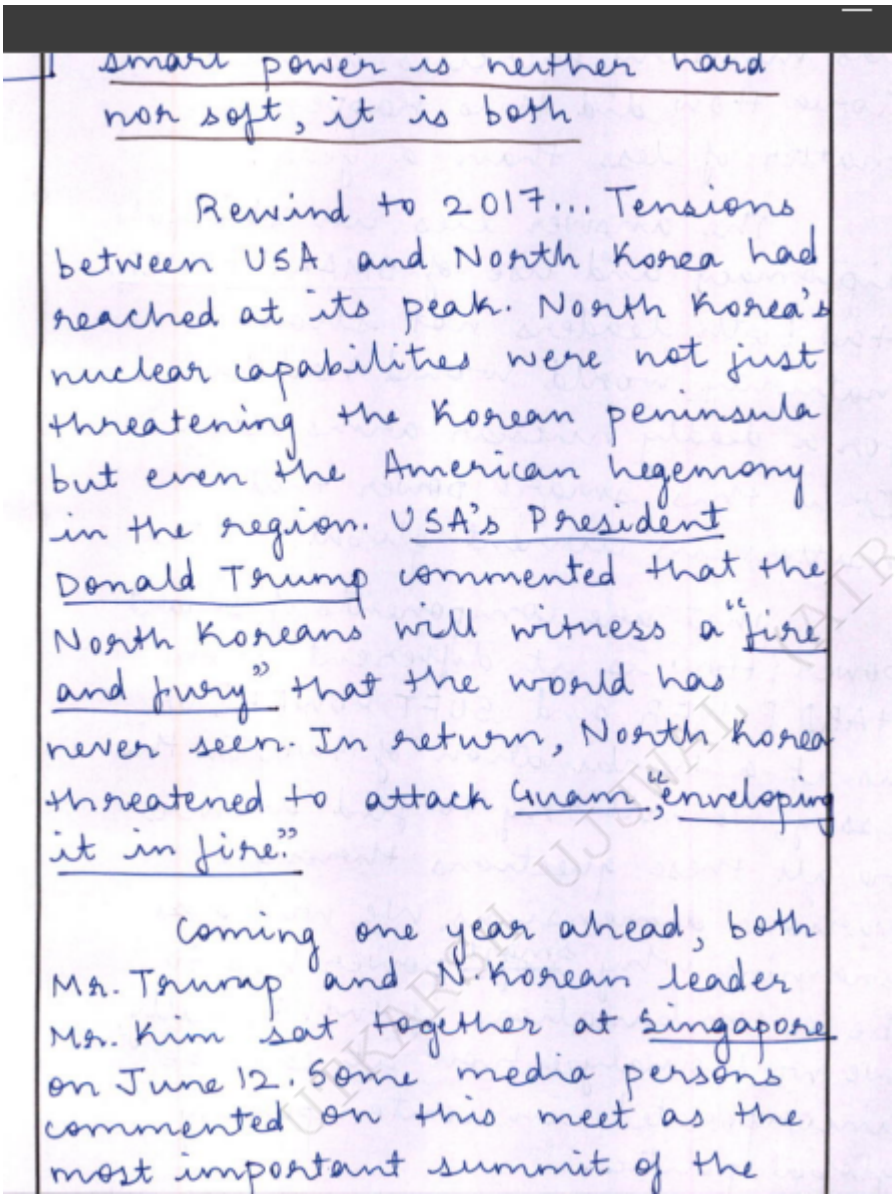

smart power is neither hard nor soft, it is both

Rewind to 2017... Tensions between USA and North Korea had reached at its peak. North Korea's nuclear capabilities were not just threatening the Korean peninsula but even the American hegemony in the region. USA's President Donald Trump commented that the North Koreans will witness a "fire and fury" that the world has never seen. In return, North Korea threatened to attack Guam, "enveloping it in fire."

Coming one year ahead, both Mr. Trump and N. Korean leader Mr. Kim sat together at Singapore on June 12. Some media persons commented on this meet as the most important summit of the

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Q → Is democracy the best setting for strong economic growth?

Ans → It is often said that "A poor person in a democracy feels worse than his counterpart in a non-democratic state". At first glance this statement seems absurd, but a closer analysis of the relationship between democracy and economic growth, brings light to its true meaning.

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From Non-Alignment to Multi-Alignment → Shift in India's foreign policy

In a small area off the coast of Hawaii in the Pacific Ocean, a diver who saw a nursery of fish everyday, observed their natural behaviour.

Even though, the small fish competed with one another for eating the plants or the phytoplanktons, whenever a shark came near their group, they huddled together to create a mirage & confuse the shark, thus ensuring their collective security. This provides us a glimpse of the world, as it is today.

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Nuclear disarmament is the need of the hour.

Abhay is an engineer working in Japan. Like everyday, he took a bus in the morning for his office, and the fully congested bus stopped abruptly on the road. Everyone's phones started ringing with the alert "A missile is coming from North Korea". At that moment, without any hope of evacuation, he along with the others in the bus, realised the helplessness in the event of a possible nuclear attack. The above experience is a real life example of the need for urgency in nuclear disarmament process to start.

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Essay

Good Nutrition is the Foundation of Human Development

'Bhaat' or 'Rice' was all 11 year old Santoshi kept asking for. However, Santoshi's family had no rice since its Ration Card was not linked to Adhaar. Santoshi's school in Simdega, Jharkhand was off due to Durga Puja Holidays. She could, therefore, not get a meal under the school's mid-day meal programme. After starving for 8 days, Santoshi died. A part of all of us, who read the news later, died too.

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Nuclear Disarmament Is The Need of The Hour

It was just another routine sortie of the U-2 spy planes of the USA over Cuba one day in October 1962. However, what it discovered was to soon bring the world to the brink of nuclear disaster. It was discovered that USSR was deploying nuclear capable missiles in Cuba - 150 km from the US mainland - in retaliation to USA's deployment of missiles in Italy and Turkey. The memory of Hiroshima and Nagasaki were still fresh in the mind of the world citizens, and there were tense moments in the 13-day long standoff when many thought that the end of the world was near. Through astute and pragmatic diplomacy, the crisis was resolved, but the spectre of nuclear wars has never subsided.

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Public Private Partnerships (PPPs) are not a panacea for Infrastructural Challenges of India

Rajat couldn't have been happier today. He comes from the small town of Baramati in Maharashtra. After a long job search, he has landed himself a job in an IT company in Noida, and the firm has sent him airticket from Mumbai to Delhi.

As he takes the journey, he passes through the Mumbai-Pune Expressway, then the Mumbai Airport, lands at the swanky new terminal in Delhi, and then takes the airport metro line. He marvels at the

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world-class infrastructure that PPP projects have helped built.

However, he also notices the low ridership in the Airport line of the Delhi metro. Out of curiosity, he tries finding out why. He finds that it was built by PPP partnership, the projected ridership never materialized, poor civil construction led to its closure for 6 months, and finally the PPP partner walked away from the project, citing huge losses. It was then taken over

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by the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation (DMRC) which is now trying various incentives to improve the ridership and service levels.

As Rajat settles down in this job, and starts using the Delhi Metro, he also notices the punctuality, huge rideship and reasonable fares compared to other modes of transport. Fully Publicly financed, and publicly built, the Delhi Metro Network has become a case study in the success of public infrastructure projects. Built by PPP, the Airport metro line, on the other hand, has become a case study in the failure of PPPs.

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'There can be no keener revelation of a society's soul than in the way it treats its children'

-Nelson Mandela

Mark and Sarah live in the city of Tampere, an hour's drive from the Finnish capital of Helsinki. Just yesterday, they received a 'baby box' from the neighbourhood maternity and childcare clinic. Every expecting parents in Finland receive the iconic baby box as they prepare to welcome their child, free of cost and fully financed by the state. The box has all the essential items that the baby would need in the first few months

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Q2

WHY DOESN'T INDIA HAVE ITS OWN SILICON VALLEY ?

Sundar Pichai, a student of India's premiere engineering institute, goes on to become the CEO of Google, driving the digital revolution of the world. On similar note, another Indian named Satya Nadella leads the operations at Microsoft. While it is heartening to see how Indians are leading the world giants of electronics and digital industry, it is equally disheartening to witness such revolutions occuring at the Silicon Valleys of America, China and Europe and not of India. Sadly, India doesn't have one.

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Independence of judiciary is the hallmark of democracy.

When Supreme Court of Maldives acquited the former president in exile of all the charges, then the current President Abdullah Yemen imposed national emergency in the state. It led to the mass arrest of the judges, media persons and in a way defeat of democracy and freedom.

When President's Rule was Imposed in Uttarakhand, India, the Supreme Court of India annuled the order on malafide ground and thus upholding the rights and freedom of the state legislatures.

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STRENGTHENING THE HEALTH CARE SYSTEM in INDIA: IS PRIVATIZATION THE ONLY ANSWER?

After a long tiring day, working at road site under NREGA, when Ramu returned to his home he found his daughter shivering with fever. This was the 5th day of her fever and yet he only hoped that it would go away in the evening itself. He went to village Public health centre (PHC) two times, but both times there were no doctors. Poor Ramu did not have money to take his daughter to one of the private hospital in city and thus he remained dependent on fate and miracle to treat her daughter.

Ramu's story is not unique. There are many Ramu's all across the country who feel helpless due to a poor healthcare

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SECTION-B

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE HAS THE POWER TO MAKE HUMAN INTELLIGENCE OBSOLETE

There was an eerie silence in the meeting room. In few moments the fate of the masters were to be decided. On trial were the creators, none other than humans. On jury were few machines created by those humans. The machines were to decide whether to terminate the masters or not, at which point the adjectives were really meaningless as it was not clear: who is the master now: man or the machine?

Welcome to the era of Artificial Intelligence. The story given

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1. Accountability in India's police Services: Who watches the watchmen?

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"IPS in India is still seen as a police force and not as a police service"

— National police Commission, 1977.

The above Comment was made by National police Commission (NPC) in 1977 while evaluating the performance of Indian police Service (IPS). Even after 40 years the same feeling persists in a vast section of society. The perception of police as a force creates a trust gap between citizens and police. more than the

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4) HIGHER EDUCATION IN INDIA : ISSUES AND CHALLENGES

On the occasion of Engineer's Day (M. A Visveswaraya's birthday) many news channels were having a discussion on the issue of higher education ~~discussion~~. What came to light was- NASSCOM's report, that only 17.5 % of the engineers in the country are employable, raising questions about the challenges of higher education in India. In this context, it is pertinent to have a nuanced understanding of the challenges of quality, access, infrastructure, relevance of higher education in India, so that we take informed steps to realise the demographic dividend

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2. **Cinema : a reflection of society or a tool of social transformation?**

The other day I chanced upon the movie "Mother India" being telecast. The penury of the Indian farmer, the villanious role of the money lender, reflected the society of first half of 20th century. Then, there are movies like Dangal, talking about encouragement of women in sports. – a tool of social transformation in a Patriarchal society such as ours where women's participation in public sphere is low. So of the pertinent question remains – Is Cinema a reflection of society or a tool of social transformation?

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1. The booming superstition market in India's Knowledge economy -

"Are you facing troubles in getting a job? marriage trouble?, foreign travel?, want to get rid of your evil and capricious neighbour?, facing health problem? want to get superrich?, not getting married?" — Worry Not! Meet Mr. X with 30 years experience near Taxi Stand. 110%. Success assured. Get full satisfaction with Money Back Guarantee!"

Does above lines ring a bell? We daily

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1

If any machine is misused, the moral evil is in the man who misuses it, not in the machine

"Our scientific power has outrun our spiritual power. We have guided missiles and misguided men".

—MARTIN LUTHER JR.

Scenario 1 : Year was 2014. Floods in Chennai had created a havoc in the lives of many. Someone thought to use the machine of internet to address the calamity. Regular updates were provided, whereabouts of rescue teams, call for relief material etc. was done through this machine. It was largely prevented to let it become a disaster.

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SCENARIO-2 : 2012, Bengaluru – The SILICON VALLEY of the nation gave birth to the FRANKSTEIN'S MONSTER. Internet machine was used to discriminate against the people of North-East, resulting into

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their mass exodus.

In both these scenario, machine of Internet was used to produce different outcomes. So, where did the mistake lied? Was it of the machine or we, the humans ? Through this essay we will

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As APJ Abdul Kalam says.

"Where there is righteousness in the heart,
there is beauty in character.
Where there is beauty in character,
there is harmony in home.
Where there is harmony in home,
there is order in the nation.
Where there is order in the nation,
there is peace in the world."

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2

EXPORT LED GROWTH IN INDIA: VISION and REALITY

Seventy-one years ago, at the stroke of midnight, India signed tryst with destiny. Breaking all the colonial shackles, it emerged as an independent nation. Going against the predictions of many in the world, it not only survived, but thrived.

The colonial rule of 200 years and drain of wealth it resulted into, had left deep impressions on the people. It is under these scenarios that India adopted for almost a closed economy. But this closed economy soon translated into Hindu rate of growth (<4%), insufficient forex reserves. This pushed India towards the LPG economic reforms of 1991.

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India has since then opened its economy to the world trade and reaped maximum benefits. Today it is the sixth largest economy of the world with

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growth rate of >7.5%. Forex reserves today stand as high as $400 billion.

Such high rates of growth have been due to many factors, with EXPORTS as a major factor. Through this essay, we will exclusively focus on the concept of export-led growth in India.

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2. The JAM system is reshaping ties between the state and citizens in India.

Manoj is a farmer who grows cotton in his village of Rampur in Gujarat. This morning he woke up to find his subsidy for fertilizer, has been messaged to him on his mobile, has been transferred to his bank account. Today Manoj has to first drop his daughter to the school. She is in eighth standard and receives a scholarship for attending above 75% classes verified by her Aadhar. The village teacher also has become regular

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following the mobile phone complaint mechanism against teacher absentism. Earlier Manoj would have to stand in the long line to purchase wheat from local PDS shop. But now he will go to the local grocery as his foodgrain

subsidy gets transferred to his bank account. This gives Manoj more time to work on the fields.

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WASTE MANAGEMENT IN INDIA : CHALLENGES AND OPPORTUNITIES

The significance of effective waste management practices was recognized first by people of Indus Valley Civilization as long as four thousand years ago. A distinct feature of cities of Mohenjodaro and Harappa is the drainage connecting each household. There were even 'manholes' on intervals for cleaning purposes.

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Indian Agriculture, is, in a way, a victim of its own past success.

Kartar Singh, a frail man of 85 sits on his charpai in his field in Moga, Punjab. He will be taking the cancer train to Bikaner in Rajasthan the next day for his treatment.

He will be joined by many other farmers of his district. United by cancer, they are all unmindful and clueless about the reason behind their suffering.

Meanwhile, his two sons toil hard in their field, praying for a better yield this year. Their crop from the last season failed due

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to alienation, making them struggle to make ends meet.

While life goes on for them, they cannot help but be nostalgic of their prosperous past. Their children are not enjoying the same childhood as they did.

What ails Indian agriculture? Why is it that despite the Green Revolution's success, the ancient golden bird country still has to see farmer suicides every day? What is it that makes farmers dump the product of their hard labour on the roads?

The essay will be answering the above questions to argue that Indian agriculture is indeed

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Defence Expenditure : Necessity or Extravagence.

It is indeed an irony that at a time when India is signing multi billion dollar deals for French Rafale Jets, our healthcare sector is struggling to provide facilities to people with a meagre budget allocation of less than 2% of GDP.

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Section A

Success of a Democracy hinges on healthy functioning of its institutions

The ideas of the French Revolution which sowed the seeds of democracy marked a momentuous shift from hereditary monarchies and oligarchies. With democracy, the average citizen could aspire for a life where she just does not exist, but her opinion matters too. Democracy is government of the people, for the people, and by the people. The individual is no longer a mere cog in the running of the State machinery, but is now the reason behind the elected government.

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Investing in human capital: Need of the hour

It is estimated that by 2040, India will overtake China to become the most populous country in the world. As the world ages, India will have the youngest population, ready to power the economy with the fruits of its labour and effort. The demographic dividend in front of us opens up exciting possibilities which could redefine the Indian experience if harnessed properly. For this end, India will have to invest massively in the development of human capital.

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1. Environment Sustainability and Economic Development : Mutually Exclusive or concordant Objectives ?

'No power on Earth can stop an idea whose time has come.'
- Victor Hugo.

The idea of environment sustainability has its genesis in the 1970s. The Club of Rome advocated this idea, and was formally mentioned in the Bertland Commission Report. Over the years, environment sustainability has become a focal point of government action and civil society engagement. The question frequently arises, that whether environment sustainability is the antithesis of economic development?

In this essay, I shall be arguing that instead of being mutually exclusive, environment

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mutually exclusive, environment sustainability shares the same

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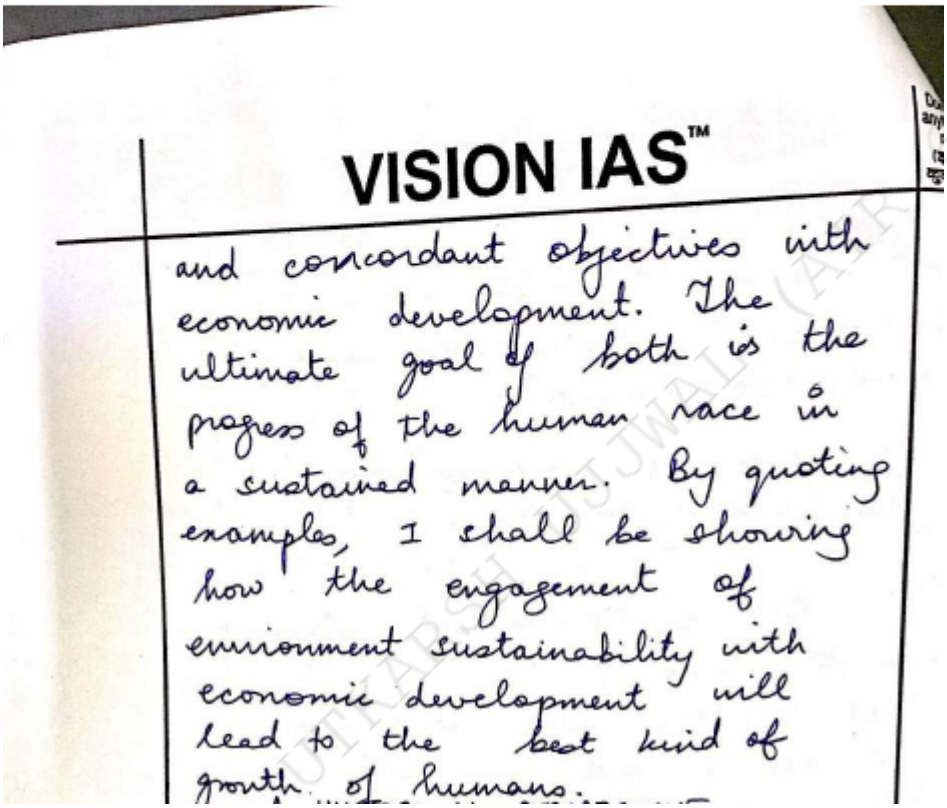

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CALAMITIES ARE NATURAL BUT DISASTERS ARE MAN-MADE

The Chennai Floods of December 2015 brought the happening and flourising city to a standstill. It took the city years back on the development path and took a toll on all the efforts made by the state towards progress and prosperity. The disasters raised many questions in the minds of people. Is it natural or man-made? Who is responsible for the havoc?

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Technology is a useful servant but a dangerous master

Humanity has progressed leaps and bounds because of the development and progress in technology. The evolution of our ancestors right from Homo Egaster to Homo Sapiens can be traced parallel to the tool and technology evolution from big stone tools to highly specialized iron equipments. Thus, technology is cardinal to human progress. However, on the other hand, technology in the form of missiles, guns, arms and even internet have taken the people of war torn areas of Middle East viz. Syria towards adversity

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POLITICS WITHOUT ETHICS IS A DISASTER

The American senator Ted Kennedy once famously remarked;

"Ethics is the lifeblood of democracy"

His quote aptly notes the utility of ethics in the political system of a country. Ethics acts as a torch of light and helps to solve political dilemmas. It is a shield that prevents abuse of authority

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SECTION A

1. Environmental Sustainability & Economic Development : Mutually Exclusive or Concordant Objectives?

One night can make a ~~make~~ big difference. Take the night of Diwali of 2016. The entire country was full of joy. Celebration of the history and culture was taking place using sweets and crackers. But, only the following morning, a smoke engulfed the city of Delhi, and remained around for days to come. Schools were shut down. Employees preferred to stay at home. Foreign embassies issued advisories and tourism plummeted. One night indeed made a huge difference, both on Economy as well as Environment.

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SECTION-A

NEED OF THE HOUR: AN ACTIVE JUDICIARY OR AN ACTIVIST JUDICIARY

"Curb on diesel vehicles 10 years old plying in NCR..., ban on firecrackers after 10..., ban on iron ore mining in Goa..., BCCI to comply with all Lodha panel recommendations,... CBI enquiry in 2G scam to be under Supreme court supervision....."

These are the headlines often seen in newspapers highlighting active role of Judiciary in ensuring true democracy in the country. All these indicate the proactive as well as reactive stances of Indian Judiciary towards wide plethora of issues. But then it poses a question - "do we need an active judiciary or an activist Judiciary?"

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ORGAN DONATION : PRACTICALITIES AND ETHICAL CONUNDRUMS

Philanthropy has always been an ideal human virtue and most evidently manifested through charity and donation. Since the dawn of human civilization, donations in terms of money, resources, skills and other intangible gestures have shown their effectiveness in adding value to the lives of poor and needy. Modern times have shown a new dimension to this sphere in terms of "organ donation".

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UNIVERSAL BASIC INCOME : AN IDEA WHOSE TIME HAS COME.

The makers of Indian constitution envisaged India to be a land free from any form of discrimination and inequality. This view is evidently manifested in the Preamble to our constitution which ensures "Justice - social, economic and political" to all citizens. But have these words translated into reality ? The grim scenario of poverty in the country tells the opposite story. Though we have been able to reduce poverty levels from 70% at independence to 21.9 % at present (Tendulkar committee report, 2009) but still there are deprivations and inequality present.

One solution to this injustice, as proposed, is the idea of universal basic income (UBI) which

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A Smart police force for a safer India.

The Prime Minister of India in his annual Speech at the "All India Police Conference" at Guwahati said that India needs a "SMART" Police force. Indian Society was ruled by the British Colonial elite who for their own Capitalist, monopolistic and greed driven interests would manipulate the police according to their own needs.

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PART- B

EDUCATION SYSTEM IN INDIA

a leveller or source of inequality?

Geeta and Priya are two young 14 year olds who aspire to become doctors. While Geeta belongs to a well to do family, goes to a public school in city and has the means to achieve her dreams; Priya on the other hand is worried if she will be able to continue her education, since the RTE Act, offers only free Primary education and her family of farmers cannot help her pursue further education

The above case shows the classic dichotomy that plagues our education system today and forces us to ponder if Education is a leveller or a source of inequality in today's time?

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CHANGE WORKS BUT ONLY IF YOU WORK AT IT

'The world is changed by your example, and not by your opinion'

- Paulo Coelho

Life is guided by only one fundamental truth, that Change is the only constant. Inspite of being an oxymoron and an overused cliche, it continues to define the trajectory of human existence. Change replenishes our bonds, revitalises old spirits and brings in a new social order.

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CULTURAL ELEMENTS OF DIVERSITY IN INDIA ARE KEY TO BUILDING A NATIONAL IDENTITY

Jawaharlal Nehru, in his seminal work 'Discovery of India' spoke about the vibrant enigma that India is because of its diversity and multiplicities. Other than him, many scholars have been, time and again left enamored by India's rich diversity.

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1) A smart police force for a safer India.

For a S ÷ Strong, sovereign, secure
A ÷ Assimilative, Active
F ÷ Free
E ÷ Empowered
R ÷ Rule of law based India,

we need S ÷ Sensitive
M ÷ Mobile
A ÷ Alert, Agile
R ÷ Reliable
T ÷ Tech savvy police force.

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2. The culture of ban, threat to democracy and diversity of India.

Gauri Shankar Lankesh is murdered on point blank, Narendra Dabholkar, a rationalist was murdered in the same manner, MM Kalburgi, a writer, was killed. With their murders, the idea of India was also murdered. Their murders was an open threat by the ~~to~~ mend ways, accede to ber community

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as unilateral, majoritarian idea of ~~other~~ India, or else!

Pehlu Khan and Akhlaq were killed for their food habits. They were lynched to exercise their freedom of expression, freedom of religion. The mob wanted to ban their food and control their lifestyle.

CBFC bans 'Lipstick Under my Burka' and calls it a 'Lady Oriented movie'. It also bans 'Udta Punjab', a movie that talks about the crucial issue of drug trafficking in India.

Lots of 'Padmavat

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AN INFORMED AND ACTIVE CITIZENRY IS THE KEY TO HONESTY AND ACCOUNTABILITY

In late 1990s, a powerful movement started in Beawar (Ajmer) by Mazdoor Kisan Shakti sangathan (MKSS) under the leadership of Mrs. Aruna Roy, a well known social activists. Her demands were plain and simple. A right to be informed about the functioning of the government, a right to know where & how the taxes incurred on the citizens are utilized and a right and medium to assert accountability on the administrators

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was all that she wanted. The movement become a country-wide struggle and soon

led to the enactment of Right to Information Act, 2005. This movement shows how an active citizenry can infuse pressure on the government to ensure accountability towards citizens. An

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VOTING IS THE RIGHT UPON WHICH ALL OTHER RIGHTS DEPEND

"The right of voting for representatives is the primary right by which other rights are protected. To take away this right is to reduce a man to slavery, for slavery consists in being subject to the will of another and he that has not a vote in election is in this case"

– Thomas Paine.

The above lines by political thinker Thomas Paine aptly captures the importance of voting as the fundamental right of a human being. Voting means

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SECTION B

RAISE YOUR VOICE, NOT THE SEA LEVEL

"Prakrathi : Rakshati Rakshita"

(Nature Protects if she is protected)

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Revisiting the ancient glory - can it shape India's future.

"Past is the window to our future"

Nelson Mandela argued that if a nation wants to achieve glory and world status, it must shed off its chains and embrace value of human life. Dayanand Saraswati talked about GOING BACK TO THE VEDAS in the context of India. Jawahar Lal Nehru at UN assembly stipulated that India must strive to achieve its lost glory and place in human civilization.

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4. THE COLD WAR IS OVER BUT COLD WAR THINKING SURVIVES.

Francis Fukuyama famously proclaimed after the disintegration of USSR in 1991 as the "END OF HISTORY". He proclaimed that history of two superpowers competing for hegemony in ## world affairs has come to an end with the triumph of USA. However, Fukuyama's assessment proved to be shortlived. Like the ancient monster Hydra, with its main head cut off, Cold War has birthed its many ugly heads. Rather than disappearing into oblivion, Cold War has taken even more dangerous manifestations.

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2. IS UNITY IN DIVERSITY OVERRATED IN THE INDIAN CONTEXT ?

Jawahar lal Nehru in his book 'DISCOVERY OF INDIA' claimed that India as a "great civilization" existed inspite of all disruptions and obstacles over the centuries because of its "unique ability to blend unity in diversity". Sunil Khilani in his book, 'THE IDEA OF INDIA' has remarked that the very basis of India's survival uptil now is due to its idea of ~~integrating~~ unity in diversity as opposed to the idea of Pakistan which believes in suppressing diversity and hence Pakistan's state of degeneration.

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"POVERTY IS THE WORST FORM OF VIOLENCE"

– MAHATMA GANDHI

It is a paradox that as India climbs the ladder of economic growth to become the third largest economy of the world in GDP terms, nearly 30% of its population continues to be the victim of poverty. Amratya Sen and Jean Drèze call this the "UNCERTAIN GLORY" of India. UNDP's 2014 Multidimensional Poverty Index holds 56% of India's population poor against education, health and standards of living indicators

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"TRUE EDUCATION IS THAT WHICH PROVES USEFUL IN LIFE AND MAKES YOU INDUSTRIOUS."

"True education does not consist merely in acquiring of a few facts of science, history, literature or art, but in the development of character."

– DAVID O. McKAY

The state of education in India at present, unfortunately, cannot be called either 'useful' or ~~cond~~ 'industrious' India may have made many strides in increasing its literacy rates from 11% pre independence to 76% at present, however, it has been unable to ~~sho~~ shake itself ~~from~~ to moving from literacy to education.

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3. Has Capital Punishment lost its relevance in a civilized world

A girl was thrown out of the bus on a fateful winter night 2 years back. It was later found out she was brutally ~~gg~~ gangraped by a group of 5 men. The whole country was agitated. As the news broke out, Delhi was ~~fl~~ On the streets shouting slogans and demanding only one thing - Hang all of them until their death. Proponents of Capital punishments would argue that

good

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these are crimes so brutal, so grotesque which shake collective conscience of society and only capital punishment can restore the faith of society in the ability of state. widespread clamour for capital punishment would ~~delegitimise~~ justify, retention of capital punishment in statute books. Democracy is after all people's rule and if people are demanding capital punishment, it must be relevant and must have its place in statute books.

In this essay, I would try to argue that people's demand for capital punishment may not really be their desire for blood but a disillusionment with a system that allow such crimes to happen. I would seek to explore reasons as to why capital punishment has lost its relevance in a civilized world and then in the

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5. Disabled: "the invisible minority" in India's policy making realm.

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[While I was waiting for my turn once MD/MS counselling starts,] [I saw a dentist, apparently physically disabled, barely ~~walking~~ able to walk without the help of his father, climbing stairs to reach the stage to take part in Masters of Dental Surgery (MDS) counselling.] There was no ramp. There was nobody other than his father to assist him. [And this was happening in country's most prestigious medical/dental institution AIIMS, all India Institute of Medical Science, New Delhi.]

tense is incorrect

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If this is how policies and programmes for disabled are implimented in the country's premier institution, we can only shuddle to think about condition of disabled in the periphery.

In this essay, I would try to argue that due to their unorganized character, disabled are the 'invisible minority' in India's policy making and that they have been left bihind in the governance and growth process and without correcting these mistakes, neither would full potential of country be realized, nor the growth would be inclusive. In the end some suggestions would be explored to make things better.

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Good

"Poverty is the worst form of violence" – MK Gandhi

When we speak of Poverty, the works of Munshi Premchand, a contemporary of Gandhiji instantly come to mind. The struggles of 'Hori Mehta' (in Godan) against the moneylender, the police and the priest and his final capitulation in the face of societal pressure illuminates the travails of the poor poignantly.

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"Disabled: the "invisible minority" in India's policy making realm".

Mahatma Gandhi, the father of the nation, firmly believed that the measure of a nation's greatness lay in its treatment of its weakest members. If we assess India's treatment of its differently abled population by this yardstick, we certainly have failed in our quest to achieve 'greatness'.

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Q.4. Has technology failed to help in the progress of humanity?

Ans: In 2013, the mighty Indian ocean was witnessing birth of a gargantuan tropical cyclone, named Phailin with potential to devour lives of thousands. However, its formation was predicted, the risk was communicated and that resulted in speedy evacuation of thousands of people from eastern coasts of India. All this was result of technology, technology to predict disasters, communicate it through satellites and transportation technology to evacuate people. That is the wonder technology can perform which was unthinkable previously.

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Q(1) Globalisation is making our societies more creative and prosperous, but also more vulnerable.

Ans One morning, two news made headlines in our national newspapers. The first one was related to an e-commerce company Flipkart, which raised millions of money through global financial markets, the another story in stark contrast to earlier one was a sad one. because it was related to farmers' suicides in the Vidarbha drylands of Maharashtra. This page of newspaper depicted the effects of globalisation on our society. At one hand it has resulted in creativity and prosperity, whereas on other hand it has made us vulnerable to global changes.

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s-(4) The cold war is over but Cold War thinking survives.

There are two pictures which made the news recently. The first picture of an infant lying dead on European beach shook the conscience of millions of people world wide. The second picture of a child dressed up as a pilot near a photograph of his father of who was a pilot of MH 17 plane which was shot down last year. Although these two pictures seemingly appear unconnected, they are manifestations of a common thinking, the lust for hegemony.

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VISION IAS

This write-up tries to suggest what this idea means and why it is not only a reality but also a sine quo non for national progress and prosperity.

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Ans 4. "Prohibition of liquor: An achievable Directive Principle"

"The degree of civilisation of a country can be judged from the social and political position of its women" said Simon Charles Fourier. The Indian civilisation though accords a very high position to its women, in practice they are facing a social menace. The liquor consumption contributes to their misery in a significant manner. We the People of India made a pledge sixty five years ago in the Preamble of our Constitution to ensure social equality and justice and thus enjoined the state to achive this in our Directive Principles of State.

However, we have not been able to achieve this. This write-up tries to explain the nature of the menace of alcoholism, the ramifications and

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"Food is the source of wealth but food production is the source of misery"

"Jai Jawan, Jai kisan", was the exhortion made by the Prime Minister Lal Bahadur Shastri in his famous speach at a rally in Uttar Pradesh in 1965. Since, then we have treaded a long path, in which we can boast our self-reliance in food production. But the condition of food producer is becoming increasingly appalling. So what has gone wrong in our enterprise?

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Vision of a Clean India: Prospects and Challenges

"If you do not clean your backyard, your swārāj shall be stinking," Gāndhījī once said while addressing his disciples at the Sevāgrām Āshram while underscoring the importance of ~~cleanliness~~ cleanliness. At that

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Topic : Globalisation is making our societies more creative and prosperous, but also more vulnerable.

Globalisation is akin to the Indian cultural value of 'Vasudhaiva Kutumbkam' which means world is one family. It involves movement of people, goods and ideas across nations transforming the world into a 'global village'. It has

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Time to shift from Green Revolution to Evergreen Revolution.

While emphasising on the importance of agriculture in the 21st century, M.S. Swaminathan says- "The future belongs to countries with grains, not guns". His message is clear - the challenges to agriculture have increased manifolds and thus timely initiatives are imperative. In

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Climate change, a real threat to global economy

It has been the first time in the last 138 years that the Indian daily 'The Hindu' ~~sto~~ had to stop its publication in Chennai. The ~~untin~~ sudden floods brought the whole city to a standstill. And its not just the newspaper, almost all the economic activities have stopped.

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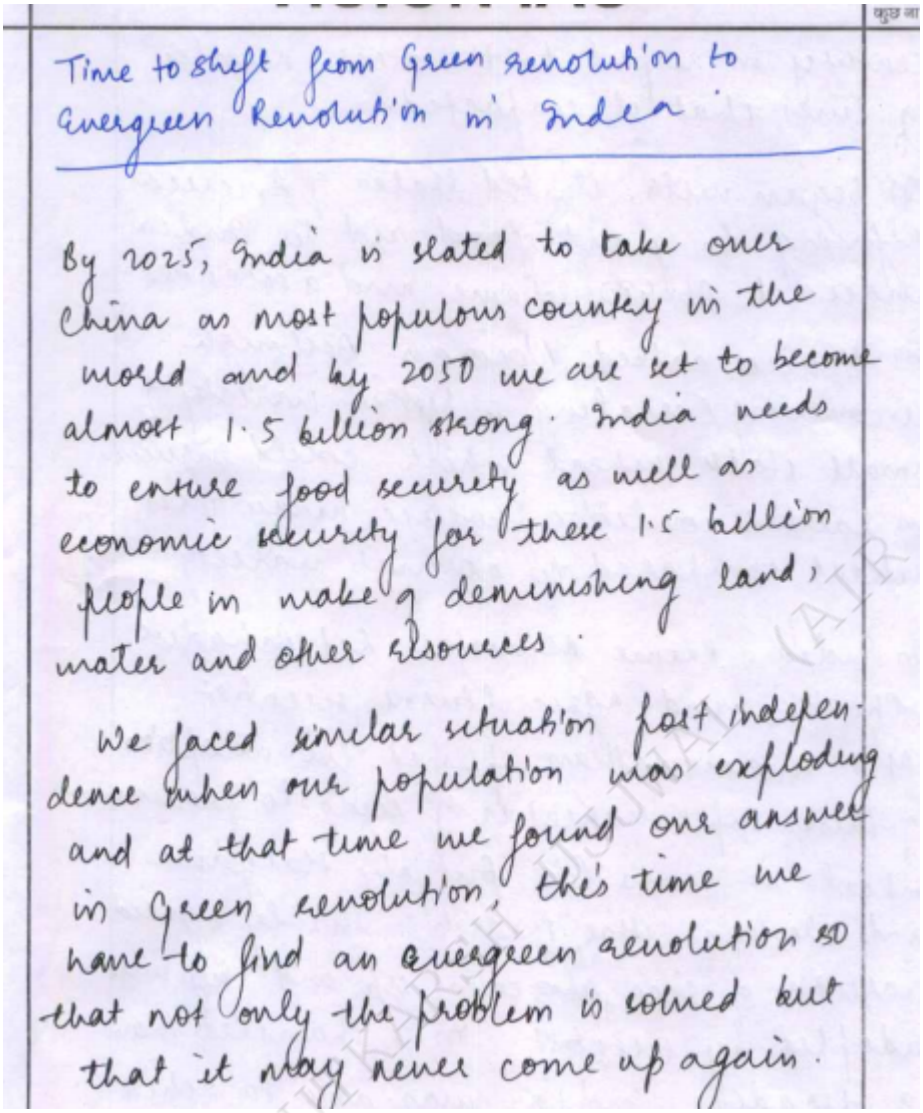

Time to shift from Green revolution to Evergreen Revolution in India.

By 2025, India is slated to take over China as most populous country in the world and by 2050 we are set to become almost 1.5 billion strong. India needs to ensure food security as well as economic security for these 1.5 billion people in wake of deminishing land, water and other resources.

We faced similar situation post independence when our population was exploding and at that time we found our answer in Green revolution, this time we have to find an evergreen revolution so that not only the problem is solved but that it may never come up again.

Arvind Singh Rank - 10, 2014

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Governance is not about institutions but about people being empowered to engage with them.

The angry young man image of 'Amitabh Bachan' in the cinemas of 1970s was symptomatic of the general disillusionment that plagued the masses in general and youth in particular in India. It was a symbolic resentment of the people against the failure of the state to convert the top-down political democracy into the bottom-up social-economic democracy. It was the latter which would have really empowered the hitherto marginalized majority of India.

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1) Indian society provides a paradox of unity in diversity along with intolerance and prejudice.

At the midnight of August 14th-15th, 1947, in the landmark 'Tryst with Destiny' speech, Pt. Jawaharlal Nehru said:

"When the world shall go to sleep,
India shall awake to life and freedom"

Their was an element of both excitement as well as anxiety in this speech. It was symptomatic of the path ahead for this great ancient civilization, which in time had picked up many infirmities in the form of caste, class, communal, regional, and linguistic prejudices.

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3. We do not inherit the earth from our ancestors; we borrow it from our children.

"A little of the Earth belongs to those who are buried, a little to those who are living and a large portion belongs to those who are yet to be born" — Anonymous.

This edifying quote sums up the need of the day — to protect the Earth not only for the memory of our forefathers and our existence, but also for the children yet to be born, our posterity, so that they can live a life of happiness and well-being.

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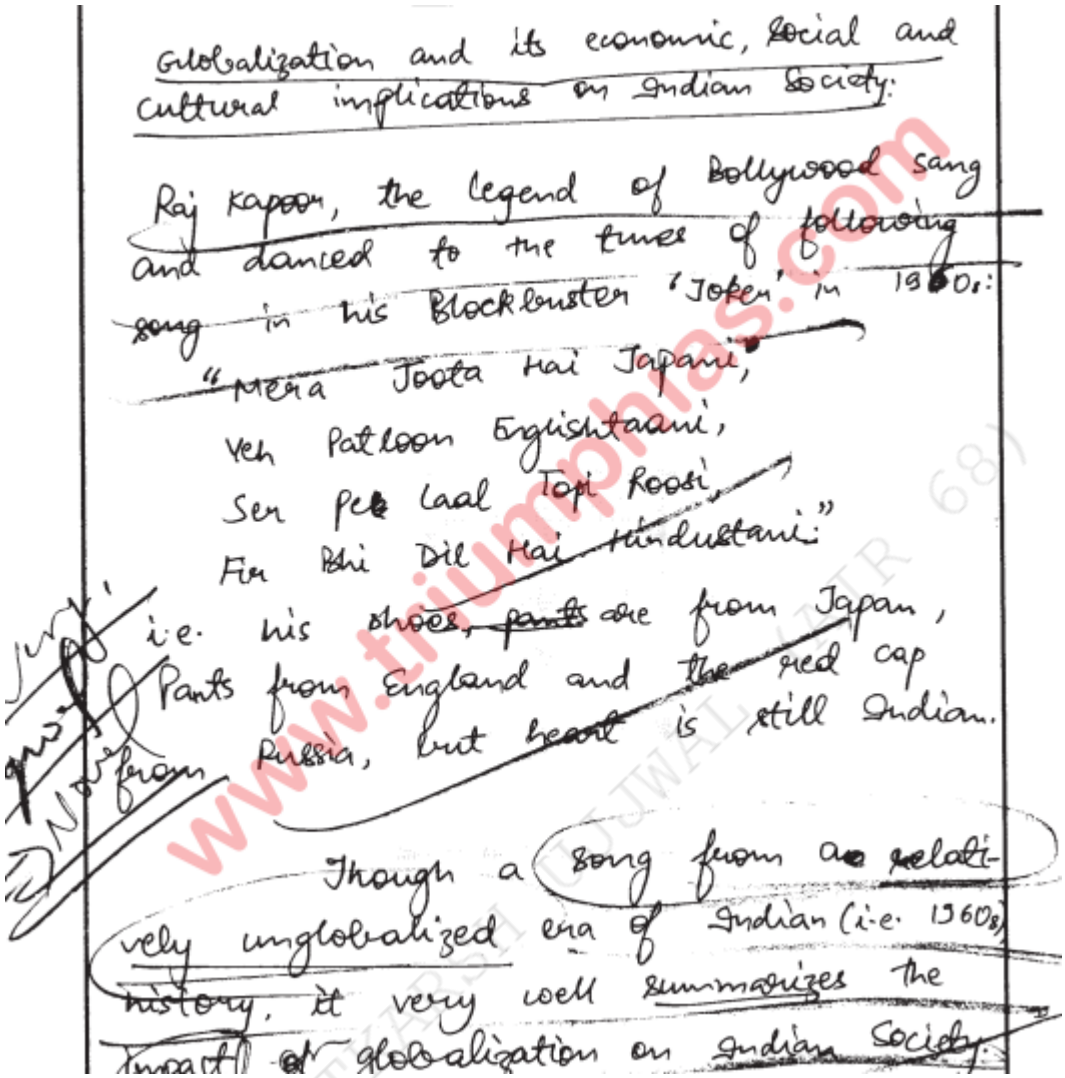

Globalization and its economic, social and cultural implications on Indian Society:

Raj Kapoor, the legend of Bollywood sang and danced to the tunes of following song in his Blockbuster 'Joker' in 1960s:

"Mera Joota Hai Japani,
Yeh Patloon Englishtaani,
Sar pe Laal Topi Roosi,
Fir Bhi Dil Hai Hindustani."

i.e. his shoes, pants are from Japan, Pants from England and the red cap from Russia, but heart is still Indian.

Though a song from a relatively unglobalized era of Indian (i.e. 1960s) history, it very well summarizes the impact of globalization on Indian Society.

www.triumphias.com
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India's focus should on Ease of Living rather than Ease of doing Business

"Vishwa Bank ki Ease of doing Business Shreni me Bharat ne lagai lambi chhalang."

(India makes a huge jump in World Bank's Ease of doing business ranking). slowly reads out Shyamu while resting near a tree shade with his handcart parked aside. A migrant labour he set out from his native Motihari in Bihar to escape the demon of poverty & poor life & arrive at Mumbai (Mayanagri as it is popularly called). It [illegible] years since he arrived

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4. **End of corruption: a future reality or Utopia?**

The year is 1757. Rival forces have started accumulating at a small village whose ground is covered with Palash flowers. On one side is the confident young Nawab of Bengal, Siraj-ud-Daulah & on the other is an aspiring power which has aims to rewrite modern history. Both are confident in their ambitions, but little does the Nawab know, that the battle has already been decided. Some of his "trusted" men have put their personal interests above bengal Mir Jafar, Jagat Seth, etc have switched their allegiance for their personal gains. Little do they know that what for them was a small act of personal enrichment

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